

CARE Nepal's Achievements

	Total
Shelter	
Total reach (people)	
Number of local artisans trained on earthquake resistant building techniques with inclusive and disable friendly concept.	1362
Number of household orientated & participated in awareness activities on Safe Shelter & Build Back Better.	19175
Number of VDC that formulated Local Disaster Response Management Plan and received Capacity Building and Awareness package on Disaster Risk Reduction.	20
Number of model house constructed including inclusive and disable friendly structure, toilet, rainwater harvesting.	4
Number of Resource Center/ Information center established with operation and maintenance plan formulated.	1
Number of Community Identified Project related to Disaster Risk Reduction implemented.	8



36 YEARS OLD MANU TAMANG FROM KHOPLANG VDC IN GORKHA DISTRICT STANDING IN A CONSTRUCTION SITE SHE IS CURRENTLY WORKING

ANNEX 1: Case Stories Learning about New Building Codes

Manu Tamang walks up through a narrow pass that leads to a semi constructed building, where a group of men are eagerly waiting for her to take advice on building a strong house. She stands among them confidently and starts to answer their questions with intricate details about the recent building codes, use of proper construction materials and techniques to construct an earthquake resistant house. The house owner feels lucky to have received Manu's time to construct his house which was destroyed by the earthquake in 2015. Impressed by Manu's skills, hard work and attention to details,

the house owner tells us, "We are so pleased that we have a trained mason like Manu who is helping us construct a strong house".

Manu has been a construction laborer from the time when she was just 16 years old. However, she was never given an opportunity to work directly on building construction. “I was only told to pick up bricks and sands, and pass it to other skilled masons who were directly involved in plastering, constructing pillars and developing foundations; but I always wanted to learn those skills to improve my income and support my family”, says Manu.

The combined income of Manu and her husband were not enough to fulfill the needs of their three children. “My eldest daughter had to drop out of school because we could not afford to pay for her school”, says Manu.

Desperate to increase her household income, Manu decided to sign up for the seven days masons training provided by CARE and its partners with the financial support from ADH.

Although Manu has been a construction labor for past 20 years, she tells us that the training has been very helpful in upgrading her knowledge. She says, “There was a different system of constructing houses before the earthquake, but now new building codes have been enforced; with this seven days training, I have learned about complying with earthquake resistant building codes while constructing houses”.

As Manu has become a trained mason, her daily wage rate has increased to NRS 1000 (USD 10) per day, which is almost double of what she used to earn before the training.

With the improvement in her family’s earning, Manu is currently saving money to reconstruct her own house which was destroyed by the earthquake. In addition, she also wishes to let her children continue their school. Remembering her eldest daughter who had to drop out of school, Manu says, “I hope my children never have to drop out of school again”. Manu’s role in constructing houses in her village depicts the increasing role of women in reconstruction. She tells, “People did not use to trust women masons like me earlier, but after we received the certificate of trained masons, we have started receiving request from many people to construct their house”, says Manu.



30 YEARS OLD KOPILA NEPALI FROM GANKHU VILLAGE IN GORKHA DISTRICT WORKING ON A CONSTRUCTION SITE IN HER VILLAGE.

Learning to Construct Brick by Brick

30 year-old Kopila Nepali pulls out a large piece of iron rod and starts taking measurement to cut them into even sizes. She is currently preparing rods to construct strong pillars that would make her client’s house strong.

The last few months have been busy for Kopila as the demand for skilled masons like her have been increasing after the earthquake.

She is usually seen on different construction sites mixing concrete in right proportion,

pouring them in different stages of construction and taking measurements of walls, woods and rods.

However, these skills were unknown to Kopila before she attended a seven days masons training provided by CARE Nepal and its partner with the funding support of ADH. “I was working as a mason before the earthquake, but people hardly called me to construct their houses as I had very few skills on masonry”, says Kopila.

She adds, “For most of the time I had to stay idle which meant that I was losing out on income generating activities”. However, when CARE Nepal came to Gankhu village with its program to train masons, Kopila was interested to sign up for it. “My husband encouraged me to attend the training because he realized that the demand for trained masons will escalate in the years to come”, says Kopila. She adds, “I am lucky that my husband is supportive; many men in the village do not let their wives work”.

Kopila’s husband, who just returned to Nepal from foreign employment, is supporting Kopila with household work when she goes out for work. With the combined income of Kopila and her husband, they are able to afford education of their three children and purchase grocery for their house.

With her own determination and support from her husband, Kopila is confident that she will get an opportunity to work as a lead contractor one day. She says, “Anything is possible if we have determination; I want to learn new skills by practicing masonry and progress in my profession so that I can make a good living out of it”. Moreover, the role of her husband in supporting Kopila can sketch a picture of a society where gendered discrimination of work is not as strong. As she smiles thinking about her husband, she tells us, “He cooks food for us and take care of the children when I am out for work. Although few men still tease us about the work we do, my husband tells me to ignore them and continue with my work”, adds Kopila.

Empowering through knowledge:



INDRA KUMARI, 36 FROM SALYANTAR VDC IN DHADING DISTRICT LIFTS UP RODS TO CONSTRUCT A LOCAL SCHOOL IN HER VILLAGE

For the last eight years of working as a mason helper, Indra Kumari had never questioned her contractor as she followed every instructions given to her. She had a little understanding of the quality and quantity of materials used while constructing buildings for her clients. However, when she attended the five days mason training provided by CARE and its partner SAHAS, she recalls myriads of instances where her supervisor led her to construct houses that severely compromised on quality and safety of the building.

Recalling Events

In the village of Salyantar in Dhading District Indra Kumari was working on constructing a house for a local resident under a supervision of a contractor. Indra Kumari recalls, “The contractor of the

house used less mortar to construct the pillars and the foundation of the house was not deep enough to sustain the weight of the house. I wish I had the knowledge about the quantity of mortar to be used while constructing the house, at least I could have saved that house from being destroyed by the earthquake” says Indra.

Today Indra Kumari is confident that she can construct safe houses because of the knowledge she received from the 5 days mason training provided by CARE and its partner with the funding support of HERMES foundation. “ Even after the earthquake, the contractor I was working with was using less cements and mortar to construct the pillar of a house. I was able to convince the contractor to make the pillar at least six inches thick so that it can carry the weight of the house”, says Indra Kumari.

Women as a catalyst for reconstruction

With more than one year after the earthquake, people in Salyantar VDC in Dhading district has gradually started to reconstruct their houses. Skilled masons like Indra Kumari has already constructed two houses in her village and she is working on constructing a building for a school which was destroyed after the earthquake. However, women masons like Indra Kumari face numerous challenges that creates hurdles for them. “ There are very few engineers in our villages, so we have to depend on the instructions of the contractors who can compromise the quality of the houses”, says Indra. She adds, “ for women like me it is even more difficult as we have to manage our household chores and at the same time we have to work and earn money”. Even though, there are many challenges for women like Indra Kumari, she is confident that she can work at par with men masons. “ I have no problem lifting up heavy objects. I have silenced those men who told I could not lift heavy objects by picking up sands, cements and rods in front of them”, says Indra.

Earning Livelihood; fulfilling dreams

As the reconstruction has geared up, there are numerous income generating opportunities for women like Indra Kumari. She tells that she does not have to stay idle these days. “The people in my village comes to me requests me to construct their houses. I have been able to earn NRS 18000 – 20000 last month which almost doubled my income compared to past. With the income Indra has been earning, she wishes to fulfill her children’s needs by giving them good food and clothes. She also wishes to send her children to Kathmandu so that they can receive good education.

“This training has not only given me opportunity to earn more income, but it has also boosted my confidence. I feel more powerful as I can question the contractor on the methods used to construct houses and advice the house owner to construct safe buildings”, says Indra.

A New Source of Livelihood



NIRMALA POKHREL FROM KHOPLANG VILLAGE WORKING IN HER FARM

36 years old Nirmala Pokhrel from Gorkha district is seen busy working in her farm, planting vegetable seeds and watering them.

The scenario, which we see now, challenges the age-old practice of only men working in the farm and earning income. Before, Nirmala’s family’s livelihood was dependent only on her husband’s wage.

However, after receiving training on improved production techniques through the program funded by TAIWAN ICDF, Nirmala has started vegetable farming in her two ropanis (42 square feet) farm. She tells us that vegetable farming has become a major source of livelihood for her family these days. Moreover, most of the vegetables

in her farm are grown for commercial purposes, and she have been able to earn NRS 15000 (USD 150) by selling these vegetables. Nirmala was interested in receiving commercial farming training and kitchen gardening training provided by Taiwan ICDF project due to the market opportunity she saw in selling vegetables. With the knowledge she obtained from the training, Nirmala has been planting vegetables like cauliflower and cabbage in her farm.

Initially, Nirmala had faced challenges to irrigate her farm due to shortage of water in her locality. But with the plastic pond and training provided by the programme, she was able to harvest rainwater to irrigate her farm even during dry season. This has been possible due to the irrigation canal reconstructed using cash for work.

In addition, the project has also facilitated interaction of farmers like Nirmala with the agricultural technician of CARE and its partner on various topics, such as selection of crops variety and methods to cultivate these crops for improving her farm produce. Moreover, she has also been able to interact with other farmers in her village as she has joined a farmer's group called Namuna Farmer Group, which has also helped her save money; she is saving RS. 100 every month through the group.

The project has had significant impact on her livelihood as she tells us that just a year before, she had to purchase vegetable from the market for her household consumption. But today, she has surplus production in her farm which she can sell to earn her livelihood.

“Mason training on Earthquake resilient building construction has widen my skills”

*CARE Nepal with its local partner Group of Helping Hands (SAHAS) Nepal is implementing **“Technical Capacity Building And Community Engagement for Safer Shelter Construction project”** in three VDCs of Dhading district. The project focuses on training local masons on earthquake resilient building technology and creating awareness on safer shelter construction.*

Pyaksi (Sunita) Pandey is one of the trainees who participated in CARE Nepal Mason training, which took place in Salyantar VDC. She has already started utilizing her skills, acquired from the training. Her reputation in the community has amplified as many households have contacted her to assist in the reconstruction of their homes. Following the training, Sunita assisted in constructing a house for Mr. Jitendra Adhikari's in Salyantar VDC. ***“the house owner first didn't agree to use earthquake resilient construction techniques as he thought it would be too expensive, but when I convinced him about the advantage of earthquake resistant technology, he agreed”*** Sunita explained. Sunita, along with Gopi Nepali and Rajendra Koirala, who were both trained through CARE Nepal, are building Jitendra's house. Their daily income has increased from 800 to 1200 per day. This income has not only helped Sunita to contribute to meet her family needs, but also contributed to boost her self-esteem. She is now a role model and an example that women can work and earn like men. This has also contributed towards decreasing discrimination against women, especially with regards to working as a mason and earning income to support their family.



The huge damage and loss from the earthquake has created awareness and the importance of using earthquake resilient techniques during reconstruction. CARE Nepal's mason training is providing local masons with this knowledge, with villagers now looking for trained mason like Sunita to build back safer. ***“We have to invest a significant budget if we have to engage masons from other places, but it's easy and cheap to build houses by skilled masons from our own village”***, says one of the villagers.